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Review Later

129

Facial Pain - Neurology

Completed: June 10, 2026, 7:15 AM

Aa

Your Score

7.5%

Average First Attempt Score

80.8%

Case Diagnosis

Trigeminal Neuralgia

Diagnosis Orders: 0%

Weight given for total score: 25%

Suggested Order

- Physical Exam: General Appearance

Reason: It would be a good idea to take a general look at the patient to see how ill the patient looks.

Suggested Order

- Physical Exam: Neuro / Psych

Reason: This is the chief complaint of the patient, so this should be examined.

Suggested Order

- CBC with differential

Reason: This should be drawn to rule out any acute infection that could be causing the symptoms of the patient.

Suggested Order

- CT, head, with contrast / CT of head without contrast / MRI, head, with gadolinium / MRI, head, without gadolinium

Reason: MRI/CT scan should be done to rule out lesions such as tumor or neurovascular compression.

Suggested Order

- Basic metabolic profile / Comprehensive metabolic profile

Reason: Chemistries are important to get to rule out other conditions.

Treatment Orders: 0%

Weight given for total score: 60%

Suggested Order

- Carbamazepine, therapy / Oxcarbazepine / Gabapentin / Pregabalin

Reason: The first line treatment for trigeminal neuralgia is Carbamazepine or Oxcarbazepine.

Timing: 0%

Weight given for total score: 5%

Appropriate Speed / Timing in the case

Reason: You had no negative patient updates prior to correct treatment

Appropriate Speed / Timing in the case

Reason: The case timed out prior to correctly diagnosing and treating the patient.

Appropriate Orders: 100%

Weight given for total score: 5%

No inappropriate invasive orders were administer to the patient during this case.

Appropriate Location / Appropriate Sequence: 50%

Weight given for total score: 5%

Correct Sequencing

Reason: Correct Sequencing of orders was done throughout the case.

Case Summary

Differential: Acute herpes zoster, Painful post-traumatic trigeminal neuropathy, Idiopathic painful trigeminal neuropathy, postherpetic trigeminal neuropathy.

The patient has classic Trigeminal neuralgia. The most common cause of trigeminal neuralgia is compression of the trigeminal nerve root (80-90% of cases). The compression is typically caused by a vascular loop.

The criteria to diagnose trigeminal neuralgia include: having recurrent episodes of facial pain in one area of the trigeminal nerve; pain lasting seconds to 2 minutes; severe intensity; sharp/electric pain which can be precipitated by innocuous stimuli within the affected trigeminal distribution.

MRI/CT scan should be done to rule out lesions such as tumor or neurovascular compression. The first line treatment for trigeminal neuralgia is Carbamazepine or Oxcarbazepine. Gabapentin can also be used, but this is second line. Surgery does not need to be consulted as medical treatment should occur and fail prior to involving surgery. The patient may improve over time and may not require surgical intervention. In this case, the patient will improve on Carbamazepine or Oxcarbazepine, and the case will end.

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